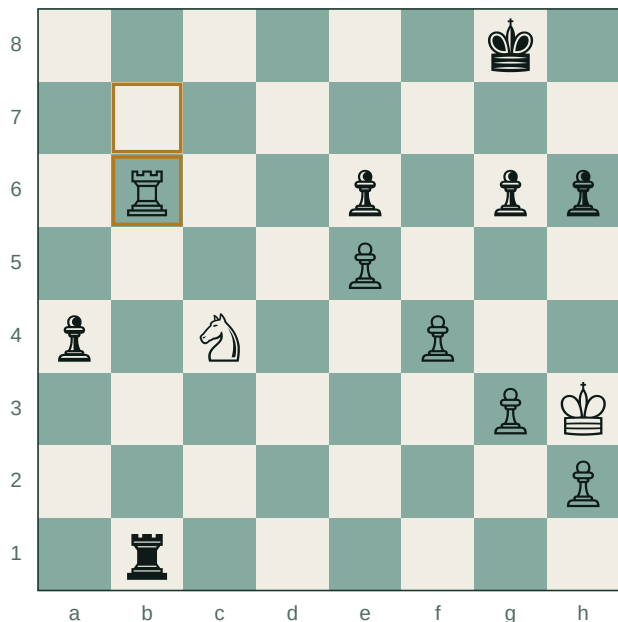


Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 48

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 48.Rxb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

48...Rxb6 49. Nxb6 a3 50. Nd7 a2

48...Rxb6 The rook captures the rook on b6. Recorded reply: **49.Nxb6**.

49...a3 The pawn moves from a4 to a3. Recorded reply: **50.Nd7**.

50...a2 The pawn moves from a3 to a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -3 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on h3. Geometrically undefended: knight on c4. Check for tactical protection.